

APPLICATION FORM GUIDE

This guide helps you complete and submit your official application for a management system audit. It explains what each field is used for, what “good” looks like, and the most common mistakes that slow down quoting and audit planning.

Form & Process Overview

The application form is divided into the sections below. You can click any section title to jump directly to the relevant guidance—useful if you need help with one specific part of the form.

[Section 1: Company Information](#)

[Section 2: Authorized Personnel](#)

[Section 3: Locations & Employees](#)

[Section 4: Audit Details](#)

[Section 5: Additional Details](#)

If you need support at any stage, contact us at contact@prok-cert.de.

Form Functionality Basics

Navigation → [< Previous](#) [Next >](#) [Save Draft](#) [Submit >](#)

There are always three buttons visible in the bottom left and right corners in the application form. On the final page, replacing the Next button, is the Submit button.

Draft Saving → [Save Draft](#)  Application draft saved successfully

On every page of the application form there is a Save Draft button, when pressed there will be a notification, in the top right, confirming it was saved. The application form also autosaves locally (on your device) periodically, indicated by a notification in the bottom right.

 Your draft has been autosaved

OTP (One-Time Password) Verification →

[Get OTP](#)

When submitting the application, you will receive confirmation and be requested to obtain your OTP for security. You will receive a confirmation notification, confirming the OTP was sent to your registered email.



OTP sent to your registered contact

[Verify and Submit](#)

You must enter this 6-digit OTP to **verify** and **submit** your application.

Accessibility →

The application form is always accessible and amendable **before** submission.

Before you start

The form will ask for company information and management system/audit details. To complete it smoothly, make sure you have access to this.

You don't have to finish in one go

You can **save your progress and continue later**, or send the draft to someone else internally to fill in missing information. Use **Save draft** to pause and return later.

Why accuracy matters

Your answers are used to plan the audit and calculate audit effort—this directly affects the **certification offer**. Missing or unclear information usually leads to follow-up questions and delays.

The Practical Example

To make the guidance practical, the guide uses one fictional company so you can see complete, consistent answers across all sections.

Example (fictional): NorthStar Cloud Solutions GmbH

- SME SaaS provider (cloud service, two sites, mixed roles)
- Includes typical audit factors: outsourcing (cloud), software development, support function, multi-location scope

It's realistic for many applicants and shows common choices (e.g., hybrid audit, multiple technical codes, clear scope wording) without being too complex.

Section 1: Company Information

Provide your organization's official details and a short factual overview. This information is used for contracts, invoicing, and audit planning.

Field	Example
Organization name <i>Enter the registered legal name exactly as shown on official documents, including the legal suffix.</i>	NorthStar Cloud Solutions GmbH
VAT / Tax ID <i>Enter the VAT or tax ID exactly as registered, including the country prefix where applicable.</i>	DE123456789

Website <i>Enter your official organization website, preferably including https.</i>	https://northstarcloud.example
Company description <i>Write two to four factual sentences describing what you do, your main activities, and where you operate. Avoid marketing language.</i>	NorthStar Cloud Solutions GmbH provides a cloud-based ticketing and workflow automation platform for mid-sized companies across the EU. We develop and operate the platform in a cloud environment and provide customer support from Berlin and Valencia.
Industry <i>Select the industry that best matches your primary revenue activity.</i>	Software Development / IT Consultancy

Common Issues to Avoid

- ⚠ Trading name instead of legal name → use the registered entity name
- ⚠ Industry reflects a side service
- ⚠ Description sounds like a brochure

Quick Checklist

- ✓ Legal name + VAT match official records
- ✓ Description gives clear overall picture of the organization

Section 2: Authorized Personnel

To ensure we communicate with the right people and know who can sign agreements. Required Roles are:

- **Authorized Signer:** can sign contracts/agreements
- **Audit Point of Contact:** receives questions, updates, document requests

One person can do both. For each person, give:

- Full name + role/title
- Work email (actively monitored)
- Phone (optional but helpful for urgent issues)
- Tick the relevant role(s)

The screenshot displays two contact forms in the Proks interface. The first form, highlighted with an orange border, is for Markus Vogel, CEO. It includes fields for Name, Position, Email (markus.vogel@northstarcloud.example), Phone (N/A), and Calendar Link (N/A). The 'Can sign contracts' checkbox is checked, and the 'Point of contact for this audit' checkbox is unchecked. The second form, highlighted with a purple border, is for Anna Becker, Compliance Manager. It includes fields for Name, Position, Email (anna.becker@northstarcloud.example), Phone (N/A), and Calendar Link (N/A). The 'Can sign contracts' checkbox is unchecked, and the 'Point of contact for this audit' checkbox is checked. A '+ Add Person' button is located at the bottom of the second form.

This Example shows a common real-world setup—legal authority and day-to-day audit coordination are often different people.

Common Issues to Avoid

- ⚠ Adding contacts but not assigning both required roles
- ⚠ Typos in email addresses (most frequent cause of delays)
- ⚠ Selecting “Can Sign Contracts” for someone who can’t legally sign

Quick Checklist

- ✓ At least one person added
- ✓ Signer role is assigned to someone
- ✓ Audit contact role is assigned to someone

Section 3: Locations & Employees

This Section is used to confirm your audit scope and plan audit activities (including whether onsite time is needed). If work is performed under your management system from a place – **list it as a location** (HQ, branch, support office, warehouse, etc.).

HQ goes **first**...

...Then add **others** with **Add Location**.

Company Information

Authorized Personnel

Locations & Employees

Locations & Operations

Headquarters (HQ)

Street Address *
Friedrichstraße 12

City *
Berlin

+ Add Location

< Previous

Save Draft

You must provide the information for each section separately. This is crucial because it affects the audit day calculation and effort immediately. You do not have to perform any calculation yourself!

Activities Performed

Describe what work is performed at this location. Include the main processes/activities and what the site is used for (e.g., departments/core processes like customer service, software development).

Example (Berlin HQ location entry)

“Management, product development, sales, compliance, and IT operations. Primary site for ISMS governance and administration.”

(Valencia support location entry)

“Customer support and onboarding, including service desk operations and customer communications.”

Why we ask this: “Office” doesn’t tell us anything; “support + onboarding” does.

Employee numbers

Add locations one by one. For each location you add, you must complete the employee fields for that specific location (not company totals).

Enter headcount per location unless the field explicitly says (FTE). Repetitive roles are not an extra employee category. It asks: **out of the people at this location, how many perform repetitive/routine tasks** (a subset of the location's headcount).

Example (Berlin HQ location entry)	Example (Valencia support location entry)
→ Full-time: 22 → Part-time/students: 3 → Subcontractor/freelance: 4 → Employees in repetitive roles: 2 <i>(subset of the people above, based in Berlin)</i>	→ Full-time: 8 → Part-time/students: 1 → Subcontractor/freelance: 0 → Employees in repetitive roles: 6 <i>(subset of the Valencia team, e.g., service desk roles)</i>

Why we ask this: Audit planning depends on how staff are distributed across sites and how many perform routine tasks (this can affect sampling and audit effort).

Shifts (only if real shift patterns exist)

Select "Yes" only if you actually run formal shifts (e.g., 24/7 support).

Why we ask this: Shifts can affect audit interview planning.

Common Issues to Avoid

- ⚠ Combining multiple sites into one entry
- ⚠ Giving total company headcount instead of per-site headcount
- ⚠ Activities too generic to understand audit relevance
- ⚠ Treating "repetitive roles" as additional people

Quick Checklist

- ✓ HQ completed first
- ✓ Every additional site added separately
- ✓ Headcount per location is complete
- ✓ Activities clearly describe what happens there

Section 4: Audit Details

This defines what you're applying for, how the audit will be run, and what appears on the certificate (especially the scope statement). It also helps estimate audit effort.

Step 1: Standard and audit setup

Field	Example
Standard selection	→ ISO/IEC 27001:2022 <i>SaaS providers commonly certify an ISMS against ISO 27001. You can choose what you need.</i>
Audit basis	→ Hybrid <i>Document review and many interviews can be remote, while onsite can be used where it adds value (e.g., HQ verification).</i>
Audit language	→ German <i>Choose the language your key people can confidently use in interviews.</i>

Certification type	→ Initial <i>First-time certification.</i>
Has the Management System been implemented?	→ Yes <i>At the time of the audit, the management system has to be fully operational</i>
How long has the management system been implemented?	→ 1–6 Month <i>Select how long the management system has been operational in practice, meaning people are using it and records are being created. Enough time to generate records, still early maturity.</i>
Are there confidential documents that auditors cannot access?	→ No. <i>Auditors must be able to access all documentation within the certification scope. If any in-scope documents cannot be made available, this may limit the audit or prevent certification.</i>

Step 2: Scope statement and exclusions

Field	Example
Scope Statement <i>A strong scope statement answers:</i> → <i>What service/activities are certified</i> → <i>Which key processes are included</i> → <i>Which locations deliver the work</i> → <i>(Often) region/customer base</i>	Provision of a SaaS ticketing and workflow automation platform, including product development, cloud operations, information security governance, customer onboarding, and customer support, delivered from Berlin (HQ) and Valencia (support office) to customers across the EU. <i>- It's specific enough to audit, aligns with the locations section, and reads like certificate wording.</i>
Exclusions <i>Use exclusions only to remove clearly defined non-scope areas.</i>	Corporate financial accounting processes not related to the ISMS; marketing campaign execution performed by an external agency.” <i>- Exclude only things that don't affect the certified service delivery.</i>

Recommended template “[Primary activities/services], including [key processes], delivered from [sites] to [regions/customers].”

Step 3: Profile questions, sector and technical codes

These fields help estimate audit effort. Choose the option that best matches your scope reality – not your ambition.

Field	Example
Types of Business and Regulatory Requirements Choose the option that best matches your sector exposure: → Option 1: You operate in non-critical, non-regulated sectors, for example general consulting or standard retail. → Option 2: Your organization is non-critical and non-regulated, but you deliver services or products to critical or regulated customers, for example an IT provider for a bank or hospital. → Option 3: Your own organization operates in a critical or regulated sector, for example a bank, hospital, utility, telecom operator, government agency, or defense organization.	Option 2. <i>NorthStar is not regulated itself, but may serve customers in regulated or critical sectors.</i>
Process and Tasks Choose the level that best matches your operations. → Option 1: Simple and repetitive work, where most work follows the same standard steps, many people do the same tasks, and there are few products or services. → Option 2: Standard but varied work, where processes are defined but tasks vary between cases and there are many products or services. → Option 3: Complex operations, where there are many different processes and interfaces, many products or services, and several business units included in scope.	Option 2. <i>NorthStar has defined processes, but work varies by customer cases, releases, and incidents.</i>
Level of Establishment of the Managementsystem Choose the option that best matches ISMS maturity. → Option 1: Established, meaning the ISMS is integrated into daily work and consistently followed, with roles,	Option 2. <i>The ISMS is operating, but maturity and consistency are still developing across teams</i>

<i>procedures, and records in place.</i> → <i>Option 2: Partly established, meaning the ISMS exists but is not fully rolled out across all areas and evidence may be inconsistent.</i> → <i>Option 3: New or not established, meaning the ISMS is still being set up and not yet consistently used, with limited records.</i>	<i>and sites.</i>
IT Infrastructure Complexity <i>Choose the option that best matches how many different IT environments you run.</i> → <i>Option 1: Low and standardized, with a small number of systems and platforms that are mostly uniform.</i> → <i>Option 2: Medium and mixed, with several different platforms or environments, for example multiple environments and supporting systems.</i> → <i>Option 3: High and diverse, with many different platforms and environments across the organization.</i>	<i>Option 2.</i> <i>A typical SaaS setup includes multiple environments and supporting services without being highly diverse across many platforms.</i>
Dependency on Outsourcing/Suppliers , Incl. Cloud Services <i>Choose the level that best matches your reliance on external suppliers for important business activities.</i> → <i>Option 1: Low dependency, where important activities are mostly internal and supplier failure has limited impact.</i> → <i>Option 2: Medium dependency, where some important activities rely on suppliers but not most critical activities.</i> → <i>Option 3: High dependency, where key business activities rely heavily on suppliers such as cloud hosting or third-party services and supplier disruption would have major impact.</i>	<i>Option 3.</i> <i>NorthStar depends on cloud hosting and external services for core service delivery.</i>
Information System Development <i>Choose the option that best matches how much software you build, in-house or outsourced.</i> → <i>Option 1: None or very limited development, mostly</i>	<i>Option 3.</i> <i>NorthStar's SaaS product requires ongoing development and releases.</i>

<i>off-the-shelf systems with minor scripts or configuration.</i> → <i>Option 2: Some development, limited in scope, such as integrations, one internal app, or occasional outsourced projects.</i> → <i>Option 3: Extensive development, where software is critical to the business and there are active development teams and frequent releases.</i>	
Sector Code <i>Select the one sector code that best matches the organization's primary revenue activity. If more than one could apply, choose the closest primary one.</i>	C.01 Software Development / IT consultancy. NorthStar's main business is software and SaaS service delivery.
Technical Code <i>Select all technical codes that apply to systems, platforms, and technologies included in the certification scope. Select only what you actually use or deliver within scope, not future plans.</i>	T.01, T.02, T.03, and T.04 NorthStar operates a cloud-hosted SaaS platform with security controls and software development in scope; T.05 does not apply.

Common Issues to Avoid

- ⚠ Saying the system is implemented when it isn't operational
- ⚠ Scope is too vague ("IT services") or too broad ("all company activities")
- ⚠ Exclusions are unclear or remove core activities
- ⚠ Technical codes selected for tech not in scope

Quick Checklist

- ✓ Setup choices are coherent (standard, basis, language, type)
 - ✓ Readiness answers match reality
 - ✓ Scope matches your locations and activities
 - ✓ Codes reflect what you actually do
-

Section 5: Additional Details

This section is used to collect additional information that may be relevant for audit planning but was not addressed in the earlier sections of the form. If a field does not apply, enter “N/A”.

Field	Example
Outsourced processes <i>List outsourced activities relevant to the certification scope. Add the supplier name if known; otherwise state the supplier type.</i>	Cloud hosting (cloud provider); external penetration testing (security provider); office cleaning (facility provider for Berlin office).
Legal and regulatory compliance requirements <i>List legal, regulatory, contractual, or industry requirements that are relevant to the certification scope. Keep it to what affects how you operate within scope.</i>	EU GDPR; customer contractual security requirements.
Relationship with a larger company <i>State whether you are part of a corporate group, subsidiary structure, or use shared services. Clarify which legal entity or entities are included in this application.</i>	Not part of a corporate group. The audit scope applies only to NorthStar Cloud Solutions GmbH.
Consultancy services used <i>Name any consultancy used to support implementation of the management system. Include the consultancy name and lead consultant if available.</i>	ISMS implementation support: SecurePath Consulting (lead consultant: Julia Meyer).
Additional notes to the certification body <i>Add information that may affect audit planning or scheduling, such as preferred audit hours, access restrictions, planned changes, or key stakeholder availability. If not applicable, enter N/A.</i>	Preferred audit hours 09:00–16:00 CET. Key stakeholders are based in Berlin. Valencia support interviews should be scheduled in advance.

Review & Submit

You have now completed all sections of the application form. Before you submit, quickly review the information for completeness and consistency.

What happens after you submit

- **Confirmation:** You will receive a submission confirmation immediately (on-screen and/or by email, depending on the form setup).
- **Initial review:** We typically review applications within **1–2 business days**.

If all information is complete, we will send your certification offer and propose next steps shortly after the review. If something is missing or unclear, we will contact you with questions first. If you have questions at any point, contact us at contact@prok-cert.de.

Thank you!